

The 'Output' chain handles packets that are departing from the system.

The 'Postrouting' chain is used to NAT packets after changing their source addresses.

The Mangle table contains five chains. These are: 'Prerouting' chain, 'Output' chain, 'Input' chain, 'Forward' chain, and 'Postrouting' chain.

The Raw table contains two chains: 'Prerouting' chain and 'Output' chain.

Configuring IPTables

To enlist previously configured rules, use the following syntax:

```
sudo iptables -L -t <table_name>
```

Here, -L=> list and -t => target table.

This command will enlist all the rules under the targeted table.

Let's take an example:

```
sudo iptables -L -t nat
```

In the above command, the target table is the NAT table, so it will enlist all the rules configured under this table. The following commands will hold good for Filter, Mangle and Raw tables:

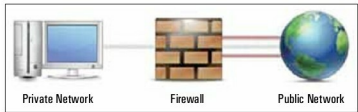


Figure 1: Basic network architecture

```
sudo iptables -L -t filter
sudo iptables -L -t mangle
sudo iptables -L -t raw.
```

To insert new rule(s) in a table, use the following syntax:

```
sudo iptables -I <target_chain> <rule_position> -t <target_table> <YOUR_RULE> -j <action_name>
```

Here, -I => insert a rule in target chain, and -j => jump on any one of the following actions:

Drop: Discards the packet silently without reporting to the user.

Reject: Discards the packet and sends an ICMP error message to the user.

Accept: Accepts the packet.

```
sudo iptables -I INPUT 2 -t filter -s 10.10.6.203/24 -j DROP
```



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